# CDSCO mandates digital batchwise clearance for high-risk pharma solvents

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India's apex drug regulatory authority, the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO), has told manufacturers and suppliers of key cough syrup ingredients that no batch can leave the factory until it is registered and cleared through the government's digital management system (DMS).

Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) Rajeev Raghuvanshi has asked state and Union Territory (UT)-level drug control bodies to direct all manufacturers, vendors and suppliers of high-risk pharmaceutical-grade solvents to register on the Centre's DMS immediately, according to a document seen by *Business Standard*.

**INDUSTRY EXECUTIVES BACKED THE MOVE AND SAID THAT IMPROPER IMPLEMENTATION COULD LEAD TO POSSIBLE CLEARANCE DELAYS, AS LICENSING AND APPROVAL REQUESTS MIGHT COME IN BULK**

"It shall be ensured that no batch of pharmaceutical grade of these solvents should be distributed without uploading the required details sought on the DMS and obtaining system generated no-objection certificate (NOC)," a CDSCO order dated October 27 states.

The order includes 10 such excipients, including propylene glycol, glycerine, maltitol and sorbitol. These ingredients are used in liquid medicines and cough syrups, and regulators treat them as high-risk for contamination.

Officials in the know told *Business Standard* that states have been requested to accord high priority to this matter and ensure strict compliance across all manufacturing and supply units. While backing the move, industry executives said that improper implementation could lead to possible clearance delays as licensing and approval requests might come in bulk.

"While the notification primarily applies to solvent manufacturers and suppliers rather than formulation manufacturers, its implementation could lead to temporary supply disruptions as manufacturers complete registration and align with the new reporting requirements," said Saurabh Agarwal, director and chief executive officer at Mumbai-based HAB Pharmaceuticals and Research.

These are likely to be short-term challenges. "In the longer run, this initiative will help strengthen traceability, improve regulatory oversight and build greater confidence in the pharma supply chain," he added. A Delhi-based pharma executive said that the move would help prevent solvents that do not conform to pharmacopoeial grade from entering the supply chain and, ultimately, the market at large.